

The image is a composite background for a travel-themed presentation. It features a tall, square stone tower with crenellations at the top, standing prominently in the middle ground. To the right, a portion of a traditional wooden house is visible, showing a balcony with ornate carvings and a railing. A vine with clusters of dark purple grapes hangs over the balcony. In the background, a vast mountain range stretches across the horizon, with the highest peaks covered in snow and partially shrouded in a soft, golden light, suggesting a sunrise or sunset. The foreground shows a misty or hazy valley with green slopes.

Sakartvelo: A Journey Through Soul and Stone

Discovering the ancient heart, sweeping landscapes, and 8,000-year-old traditions of Georgia.

The Deep Roots of Sakartvelo

1

1.8 Million Years Ago

Dmanisi Discoveries.

Skulls found here represent some of the earliest humans discovered outside Africa.

2

Reclaiming of Discoveries.
Kathenous first sanitizing the insirited source myths of the Goldm River.

337 CE

Adoption of Christianity.

One of the first nations to adopt it as a state religion, marked by St. Nino's wooden cross at Jvari.

3

4

5th Century

Founding of Tbilisi.

Built upon bubbling sulfur springs along the Mtkvari River.

4th Century BCE

Ancient Colchis.

Kingdoms form; Kutaisi serves as a capital nearly 3,000 years ago, inspiring the Greek myth of the Golden Fleece.

The Georgian Alphabet

A unique 33-letter rounded script, unconnected to any other linguistic family, celebrated nationally on April 14th.

Tbilisi: Where Empires Meet



Architectural Anatomy: The Tbilisi Courtyard



Sentinels of the Sky: The Mountain Watchtowers

High in the Greater Caucasus, medieval families built terrace fortresses and tower-houses to withstand avalanches, earthquakes, and invaders.



1

Svaneti Towers

Reaching up to five stories high, these structures feature stone walls thick enough to survive centuries of seismic activity.

2

Ushguli

Sitting at 2,100 meters beneath the 5,193m peak of Mt. Shkhara, it stands as Europe's highest permanently inhabited settlement.

3

Shatili

A remote Khevsureti village consisting of terraced stone fortresses stepping up the mountainside, connected by internal passages.

The High Caucasus Diagnostic

Svaneti	Kazbegi (Stepantsminda)	Tusheti & Khevsureti
		
 Heavily glaciated (Mt. Shkhara, Mt. Ushba).	 Dramatic Darial Gorge.	 Ultra-remote, steep slate-roofed villages (Omalos, Dartlo).
 Iconic stone Koshkebi towers.	 Gergeti Trinity Church (2,170m).	 Deeply preserved ancient pagan & Christian traditions.
 Accessible until late October.	 Accessible year-round via the Georgian Military Highway.	 Dangerous Abano Pass. Strictly summer/early autumn (closes mid-October).

Carved from the Earth: The Cave Cities

David Gareja (6th Century)

Spread across the semi-desert border with Azerbaijan.
Hundreds of cave monasteries featuring vibrant, medieval frescoes perfectly preserved by the dry desert air.

Vardzia (12th Century)

Built by Queen Tamar into a sheer cliff face.
A subterranean city designed to house thousands, complete with hidden wine cellars, stables, and a complex network of secret passages.

8,000 Years in the Making: The Qvevri Tradition

The Harvest
Grapes are crushed in the marani.

The Qvevri

A large, beeswax-lined clay vessel buried underground. The surrounding earth naturally regulates the fermentation temperature.

The Fermentation
Grape juice, skins, and stems (chacha) are left to ferment together for months.

The Profile

The clay and extended skin contact absorb harsh edges, creating deep, earthy flavors unique to the Kakheti region.



The Rhythm of Rtveli

Running from September through October, Rtveli is not a staged festival—it is a country-wide mobilization. Families reunite to harvest Rkatsiteli and Saperavi grapes in Kakheti.

The Press

Strangers are welcomed into the marani to help press the harvest.

The Sweetness

Freshly pressed grape juice is boiled into tatara (pudding) and used to coat strings of walnuts, creating fresh, pliable churchkhela.

The Golden Window: Autumn Travel Timeline

28°C

-2°C

SEPTEMBER (8–28°C)

Summer's Graceful Exit

Rtveli begins in Kakheti.
“Velvet season” on the Black Sea coast. High mountain trails remain fully open.

OCTOBER (3–22°C)

The Golden Month

The **Tbilisoba Festival** lights up the capital. Peak mountain foliage arrives.
Svaneti and **Kazbegi** remain open, but remote **Tusheti** passes close.

NOVEMBER (–2–14°C)

The Quiet Season

Mountain hiking ends. The focus shifts indoors: empty museums, robust cafe culture, and lower travel prices.

Grape Harvest

City Festivals

Mountain Hiking

The Subtropical Contrast: The Black Sea Coast

Where the Lesser Caucasus collide with the sea, the landscape transforms. The Adjara and Guria regions boast high humidity and subtropical microclimates.

Kolkheti National Park

Spanning 28,940 hectares, this unique coastal wetland ecosystem is a sanctuary for ecotourism, harboring peatlands, coastal swamps, and over 190 bird species including the endangered Dalmatian Pelican.



Finding Your Shore: A Coastal Comparison

Batumi: The Jewel



Lively, avant-garde architecture (130m Alphabet Tower), sprawling 19th-century botanical gardens, and vibrant nightlife.

Kobuleti: The Retreat



Long, relaxing pebble beaches adjacent to protected wetlands and nature reserves.

Ureki & Magnetiti: The Healer



Famous for its dark, iron-rich magnetic sands believed to possess therapeutic properties. Shallow, warm waters ideal for families.

Anaklia & Grigoleti: The Contrasts



Anaklia offers modern beachfronts and summer music festivals, while Grigoleti provides off-the-beaten-path tranquility surrounded by lush pine forests.

The Mythology of Nature

Prometheus Cave

A vast subterranean network where colored lights reveal underground rivers and limestone formations that took millions of years to grow.

Martvili Canyon

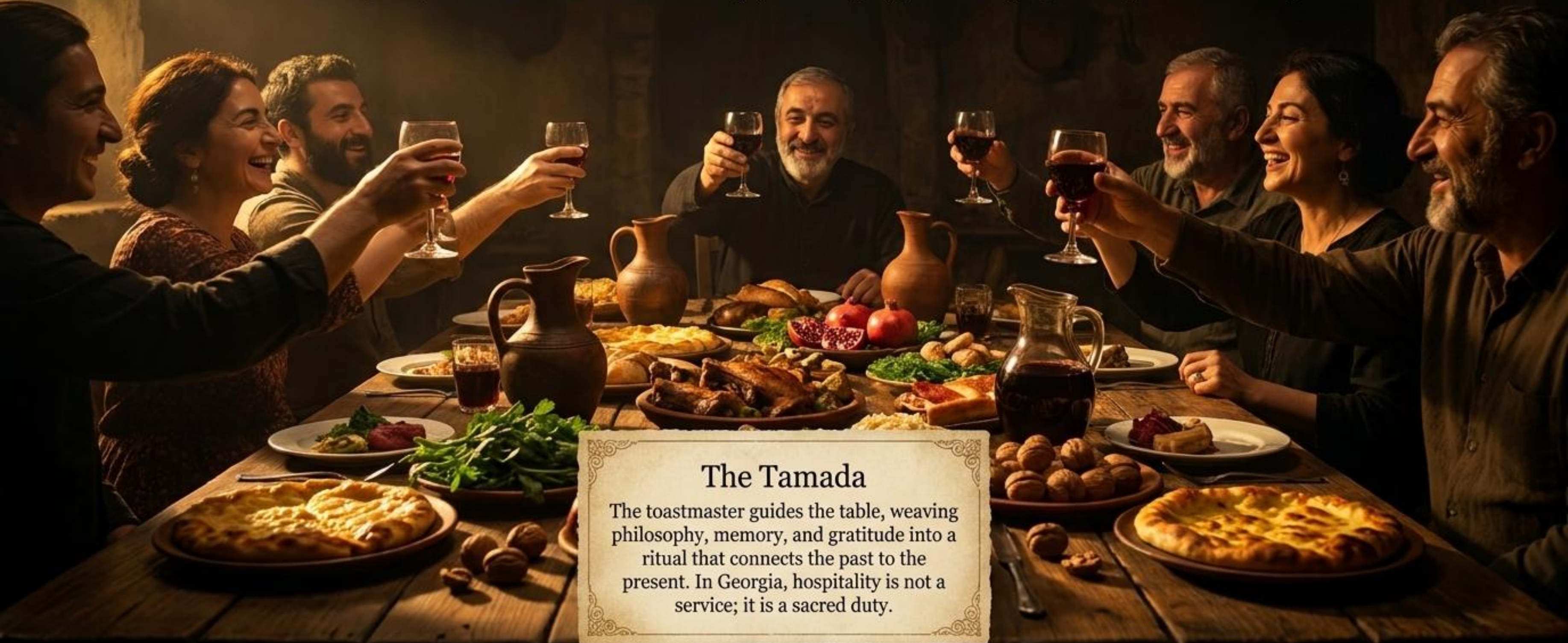
Turquoise waters carve through sheer limestone walls embedded with the fossils of ancient sea creatures. Navigable by small boats passing under natural bridges.

The Legacy of Colchis

These waterways flow through the ancient lands of Kutaisi, the mythological kingdom where Jason and the Argonauts sought the Golden Fleece.

The Supra: A Synthesis of the Georgian Soul

The traditional Georgian feast is the culmination of the country's elements. It is the wine drawn from the subterranean qvevri, the harvest of the fertile valleys, and the polyphonic singing echoing the mountain peaks.



The Tamada

The toastmaster guides the table, weaving philosophy, memory, and gratitude into a ritual that connects the past to the present. In Georgia, hospitality is not a service; it is a sacred duty.



The Timeless Invitation

Sakartvelo is not just a place on a map; it is a memory etched into stone and vine, waiting to be rediscovered.

Plan your journey through the South Caucasus at Georgia.to.
Small-group tours, deep cultural immersion, and 8,000 years of hospitality.